# COMMERCIAL ITEM DESCRIPTION

## PEPPERS, PICKLED, CHERRY AND JALAPENO

**The U.S. Department of Agriculture has authorized the use of this Commercial Item Description in preference to Federal Specification JJJ-P-1865.**

This Commercial Item Description (CID) covers pickled, hot cherry or jalapeno peppers.

**Salient characteristics.**

The solicitation, contract, or purchase order shall specify the type of product desired. If the purchaser includes other ingredients than in the types below, the ingredients must be specified in the solicitation, contract, or purchase order.

**Types.**

Type I - Hot cherry peppers. The peppers shall be either whole green or mixed whole green and whole red. If cherry peppers are mixed, the red peppers shall not exceed 20 percent by count. Vinegar and salt brine with or without preservatives shall be added.

Type II - Jalapeno peppers. The peppers shall be generally whole green. Mixed green or red peppers shall not exceed 10 percent by count. Pepper size shall be at least 1/2 inch in diameter and 1 1/2 inches in length. 1/ Vinegar and salt brine with or without seasonings and vegetable oil shall be added.

1/ "Diameter" means the greatest dimension measured at right angles to the longitudinal axis. "Length" means the greatest overall length measured in a straight line parallel to the longitudinal axis, exclusive of the stem.

Product shall be prepared from clean, sound, whole peppers with stems. Product may be prepared from fresh peppers or previously salted stock. Fresh peppers should be of the latest season's crop.

Peppers shall be practically free from defects which materially affect the appearance or eating quality. Presence of foreign material, evidence of rodent or insect infestation, extraneous material, off-odors, off-flavors, and off-colors shall be cause for rejection.

FSC 8950

AMSC N/A

**DISTRIBUTION STATEMENT A.** Approved for public release; distribution is unlimited.

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The finished product shall possess a firm texture, which is not noticeably soft and is characteristic for properly prepared peppers. The pH of the peppers shall be less than 4.0. Determination of pH shall be made in accordance with the Official Methods of Analysis of the Association of Official Analytical Chemists, Chapter: Vegetable Products, Processed; pH of Acidified Foods. The vinegar and salt brine shall cover or practically cover the peppers. No artificial coloring shall be added.

**Contractor's certification.**

By submitting an offer, the contractor certifies that the product offered meets the specified salient characteristics and requirements of this CID; conforms to the producer's own specifications and standards, including product characteristics, manufacturing procedures, quality control procedures, and storage and handling practices; has a national or regional distribution from storage facilities located within the United States, its territories, or possessions; and is sold on the commercial market. The Government reserves the right to determine proof of such conformance prior to the first delivery from point of origin and any time thereafter, up to and including delivery at final destination, as may be necessary to determine conformance with the provisions of the contract.

**Regulatory requirements.**

The delivered product shall comply with all applicable Federal and State mandatory requirements and regulations relating to the preparation, packaging, labeling, storage, distribution, and sales of the product in the commercial marketplace. The delivered product shall comply with all applicable provisions of the Federal Food, Drug, and Cosmetic Act and regulations promulgated thereunder.

**Quality assurance.**

When required in the solicitation, contract, or purchase order, the Processed Products Branch, Fruit and Vegetable Division, Agricultural Marketing Service, U.S. Department of Agriculture, will determine the quality assurance of the peppers according to Processed Products Branch procedures. The product shall be examined and/or analyzed in accordance with applicable provisions in the CID, and when applicable, the United States Standards for Condition of Food Containers currently in effect on the date of the solicitation.

**Preservation, packaging, packing, labeling, and marking.**

The peppers shall be preserved, packaged, packed, labeled, and case marked in accordance with good commercial practice. Commercial labeling and packaging, as may be augmented by the solicitation, contract, or purchase order, shall be acceptable. Shipping containers shall comply with the National Motor Freight Classification or Uniform Freight Classification, as applicable.



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For Department of Defense procurements.

The following requirements are applicable when specified by the contracting officer:

A. Commercial packaging. The product shall be packaged in accordance with good commercial practice and as specified in Table I.

TABLE I. Packaging Parameters

| Type | Unit Pack | Drained Weight | No. Per Shipping Container |
|---|---|---|---|
| Type I | 1-quart jar | 18 oz. | 12 |
| Type I | 1-gallon jar | 72 oz. | 4 |
| Type II | 603 x 700 can | 64 oz. | 6 |

B. Commercial packing. The product shall be packed in a manner to ensure carrier acceptance and safe delivery at destination at the lowest transportation rate for such supplies. The shipping container shall be in accordance with the Uniform Freight Classification or National Motor Freight Classification, as applicable. The number of packages per shipping container shall be as specified in Table I.

C. Export packaging. Sufficient peppers to obtain a drained weight of 64 ounces shall be packaged in a size 603 x 700, open-top style, round, metal can with soldered side seam and compound-lined, double-seamed ends. The can shall be made throughout from not less than nominal 1.25/0.25-pound tinplate per base box, and shall be coated overall on the inside with an enamel suitable for the product. Alternatively, the can ends may be fabricated from ECCS plate, fully enameled both inside and out. Cans shall have the interior side seam striped. The can shall be coated overall on the outside with a coating conforming to Type I, or when specified, Type III of TT-C-495.

D. Export packing. Six cans, arranged 3 in length, 2 in width, and 1 in depth shall be packed in a fiberboard box constructed, closed, and reinforced in accordance with Style RSC, V3c, V3s, or V4s of PPP-B-636. Style RSC boxes may be top-opening or end-opening. Reinforcement shall be limited to nonmetallic strapping or pressure-sensitive, adhesive, filament-reinforced tape.

E. Unit loads (commercial and export). Shipping containers shall be arranged in unit loads in accordance with MIL-L-35078. When unit loads are strapped, strapping shall be limited to nonmetallic strapping, except for Type II, Class F loads.

F. Labeling (commercial and export). Commercial labeling shall be acceptable.

G. Marking (commercial and export). Marking of shipping containers and unit loads shall be in accordance with MIL-STD-129.



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Notes.

Sources of documents:

Sources of nongovernmental documents are as follows:

Copies of the National Motor Freight Classification may be obtained from:

National Motor Freight Traffic Association, Inc., Agent
National Motor Freight Classification
American Trucking Associations, Inc., Traffic Department
2200 Mill Road
Alexandria, VA 22314

Copies of the Uniform Freight Classification may be obtained from:

Uniform Classification Committee, Agent
Uniform Freight Classification
Uniform Classification Committee, Suite 1120
222 South Riverside Plaza
Chicago, IL 60606

Copies of Official Methods of Analysis of the Association of Official Analytical Chemists may be obtained from:

Association of Official Analytical Chemists
1111 North 19th Street, Suite 210
Arlington, VA 22209

Sources of governmental documents are as follows:

Copies of the United States Standards for Condition of Food Containers are available from:

Director
Market Research and Development Division
Agricultural Marketing Service
U.S. Department of Agriculture
Washington, DC 20250

Applicable provisions of the Federal Food, Drug, and Cosmetic Act are contained in 21 CFR Parts 1 to 199. This three-volume set may be purchased from:

Superintendent of Documents
U.S. Government Printing Office
Washington, DC 20402



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Civil agencies may obtain copies of this CID from:

General Services Administration
Specifications Unit (WFCIS)
Room 6039
7th and D Streets, SW
Washington, DC 20407

Military activities should submit request for copies of this CID to:

Naval Publications and Forms Center
5801 Tabor Avenue
Philadelphia, PA 19120

Comments and suggestions.

Comments and suggestions regarding this CID should be submitted to:

U.S. Army Natick Research,
Development and Engineering Center
ATTN: STRNC-ESS
Natick, MA 01760-5014

MILITARY INTERESTS:

Custodians

Army - GL
Navy - SA
Air Force - 50

Review Activities

Army - MD, TS
Navy - MC, MS
DP - SS

CIVIL AGENCY COORDINATING ACTIVITIES:

DOJ - BOP
HHS - FDA, NIH
USDA - MRD
VA - OSS

PREPARING ACTIVITY:

Army - GL

Project No. 8950-0309



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